

Comparing length, mass, capacity and duration

compare directly and indirectly and order objects and events using attributes of length, mass, capacity and duration, communicating reasoning.

Learning intention

- compare directly and indirectly and order objects and events using attributes of length, mass, capacity and duration, communicating reasoning.

Teach and model

- using a piece of string to indirectly compare the length of several objects.
- ordering the mass of 3 or more objects such as rocks, using hefting and balance scales; using comparative language to explain the order: lightest.
- creating sand timers from everyday items or recycled material and comparing them to order the duration of time required for the sand to run through.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.